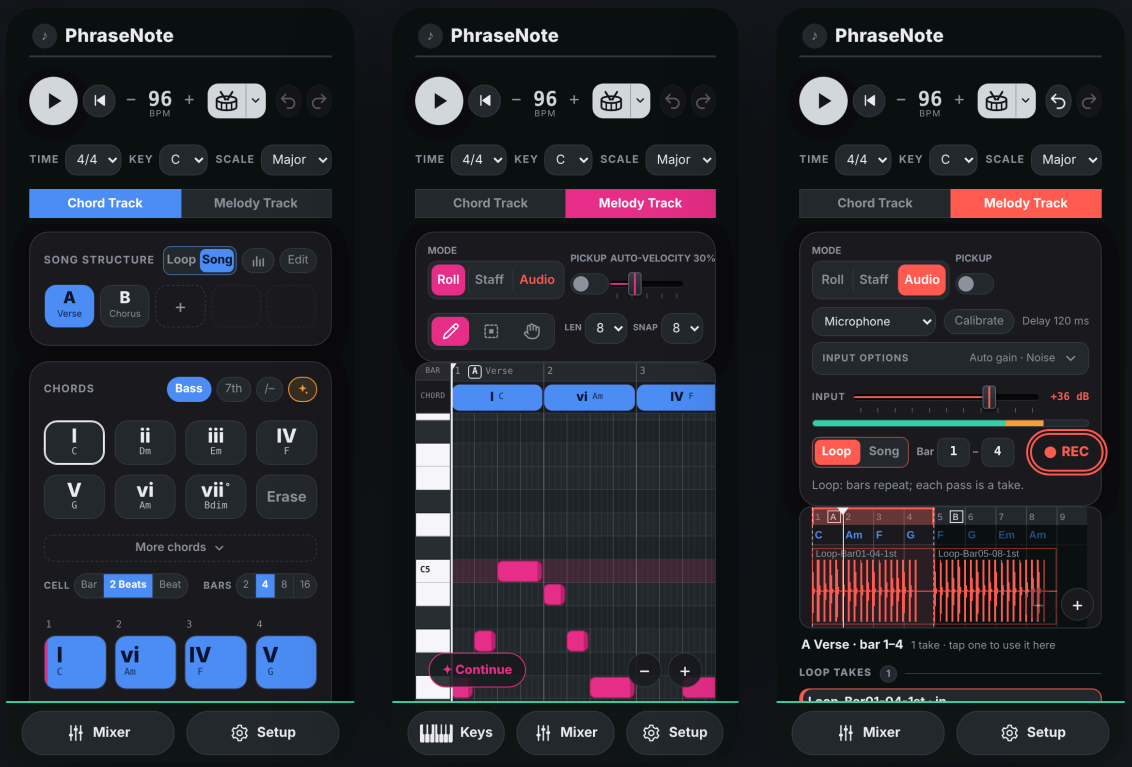
PhraseNote v0.21.5

PhraseNote User Guide

A chord and melody sketching web app for mobile (Android)



Overview

PhraseNote is a composition sketch web app for capturing musical ideas on a phone and hearing them right away.

It is built around two axes: the **Chord Track**, where you set the harmony and structure of the song, and the **Melody Track**, where you write a melody over it or record it by singing.

Everything else — accompaniment, bass, drums, dynamics — is automated or reduced to a few settings, so you do not have to handle the details. Results are saved as MIDI and WAV files to continue in a DAW.

Key features

- **Random progressions** — one tap generates a chord progression that fits the key and scale.
- **Chords from the melody** — written the melody first? The app suggests fitting chords and estimates the key.
- **Automatic accompaniment** — pick a style and the accompaniment pattern and bass line follow the chords.
- **Auto-Velocity** — melody dynamics follow the beat automatically for a natural feel.
- **Genre drum patterns** — choose from many genres or edit your own.
- **Loop-based growth** — keep writing over a looping section and the song structure extends itself.
- **Take selection per section** — record several takes and pick the best one for each section to make one melody.
- **MIDI and WAV together** — saving a project also writes the MIDI and audio files.
- **Next section by song role** — chords, accompaniment and drum changes suited to Intro · Verse · Pre-chorus · Chorus · Bridge · Outro.
- **Key and tempo per slot** — lift the last chorus or slow one part down, slot by slot.
- **Continue the melody** — a dashed two-bar idea grown from your last phrase.
- **Audio clip editing** — split, delete, move and trim recorded clips, and fill gaps with another take.
- **SoundFont playback** — play with the built-in GeneralUser GS or any SoundFont (.sf2) file you load.

Getting started

- **App address** https://minux22.github.io/PhraseNote/
- **Install with Samsung Internet** Open the address, then Menu (☰, bottom right) → Add page to → Home screen → Add. If an install icon shows in the address bar, that works too.
- **Install with Chrome** Open the address, then Menu (⋮ , top right) → Install app or Add to Home screen → Install.
- Installed, it opens full screen from its home-screen icon and works offline after the first visit.
- **Built-in sounds** On first launch the GeneralUser GS bank (about 31 MB) is downloaded once and kept on the phone. With Data Saver on it is not fetched automatically; Setup can fetch it.
- **Updates** After a new version is out, close the app completely and open it twice (the first opening downloads it, the second uses it). The version is shown at the bottom.
- **Auto-save** Your work and recordings are kept on the phone as you edit. To back up or move to another device, make a file with Save project in Setup.
- **The usual flow** Build the chords, accompaniment and drums in the Chord Track → write or sing the melody in the Melody Track → balance it in the mixer → Save project.

Contents

Chord Track

1 · Main screen

2 · Song structure

3 · Next section

4 · Key and tempo per slot

5 · Chords

6 · Accompaniment

7 · Drums

Melody Track

8 · Piano roll (Roll)

9 · Continue the melody

10 · Staff

11 · Playing it in (Keys)

12 · Quantize

13 · Key and chords from the melody

14 · Singing (Audio)

15 · Editing audio clips

16 · Keep going with Loop

Sound and saving

17 · Mixer

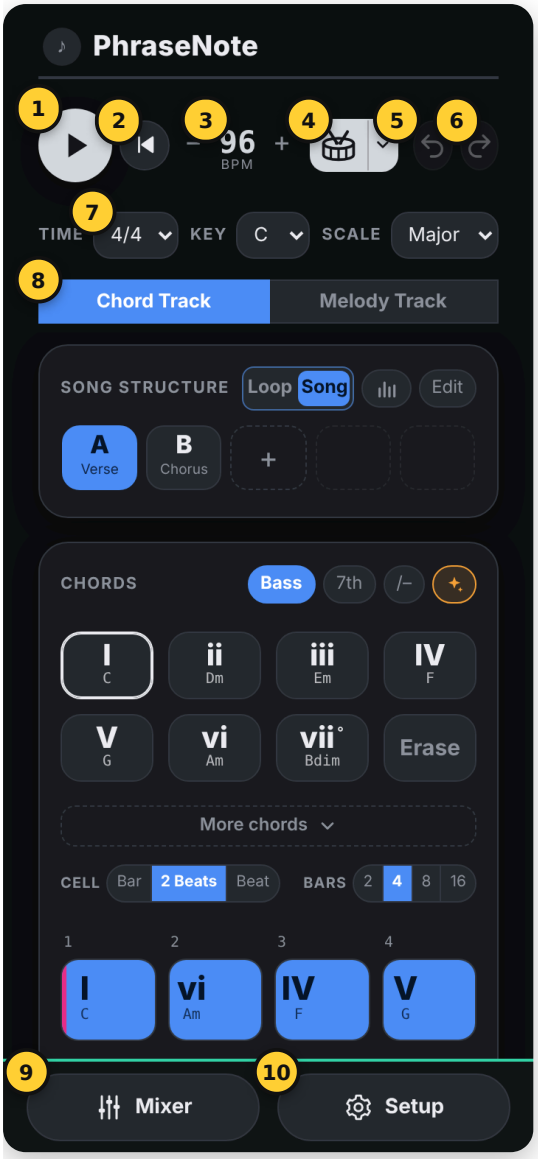
18 · Sound (SoundFont)

19 · Saving and opening

20 · Notes

1 Main screen

The top part works the same in the Chord Track and the Melody Track.

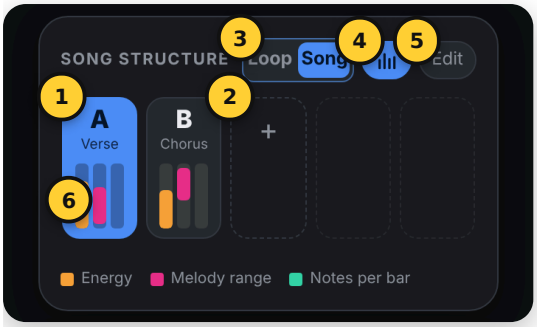


1. Play / Stop, from the playhead (white line).
2. Back to the start of the song.
3. BPM: − + steps by one, or tap the number to type (40–200).
4. Drums on / off. On, the chosen pattern plays along.
5. Open the drum pattern list (chapter 7).
6. Undo / Redo for chords, melody and song structure.
7. Time · Key · Scale. “Guess from melody…” at the top of the Key list guesses the key (chapter 13).
8. Chord Track / Melody Track. Switching does not stop playback.
9. Open the mixer (chapter 17).
10. Open Setup: saving, opening, sound (chapters 18 · 19).

> The bottom buttons (Keys · Mixer · Setup) open one panel at a time; opening one closes the other.

2 Song structure

A song is a row of slots, each playing a section (A, B …). The same section can be used in several slots.

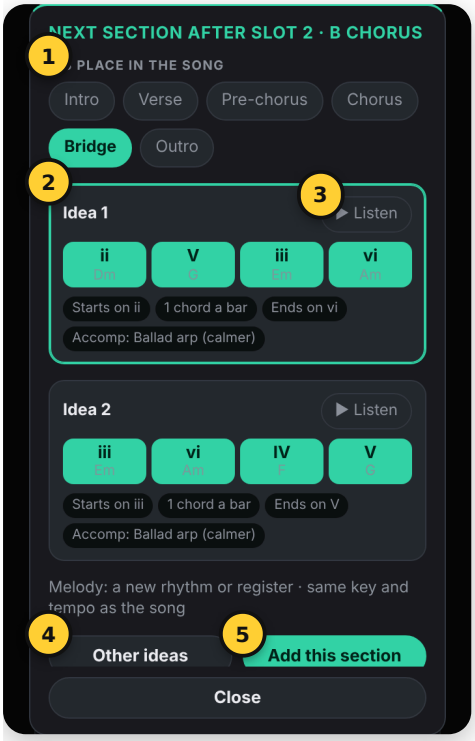


1. Slot: tap to select; the chord grid below shows its section. Long-press and drag sideways to reorder.
2. + : add a slot — a suggested next section (chapter 3), a new section, a repeat of one, or a section imported from another project file. New sections take the current length.
3. Loop / Song: Loop repeats the selected slot, Song plays the whole song. For Loop in the Melody Track see chapter 16.
4. Overview: shows three bars in every slot.
5. Edit: change the slot's section, give it a role, set its key and tempo (chapter 4), move, duplicate or delete.
6. The bars, left to right: Energy (drums and accompaniment), melody range (lowest to highest note) and notes per bar — the song's arc at a glance, and the flat stretches.

> A slot with its own key or tempo shows +2 or ♩ 90 in its corner.

3 Next section

In + choose "✦ Suggest the next section…": ideas for the section after the selected slot, by its role in the song. Key and tempo stay the song's, so the flow carries on.

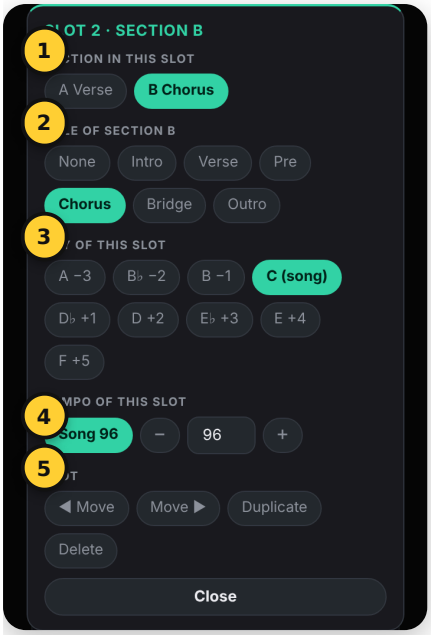


1. Its place in the song: Intro · Verse · Pre-chorus · Chorus · Bridge · Outro. The natural next step is preselected (after a Verse, the Pre-chorus).
2. Ideas: two progressions for that role. A Pre-chorus heads for V; a Chorus often starts away from the tonic (on IV, say). Tags show the first and last chord, how often chords change, and the accompaniment and drum changes.
3. Listen: hear the idea with its accompaniment and drums.
4. Other ideas: more progressions.
5. Add this section: add the chosen idea as a new section. If a section with that role exists, "Use A again" repeats it.

> Accompaniment and drums follow the song's Verse: a step up for the Chorus, a step down for Intro · Bridge · Outro. The melody hint at the bottom is advice only; it adds no notes.

4 Key and tempo per slot

In the slot menu (Edit), give a slot its own key and tempo — a lifted last chorus, a slower bridge.

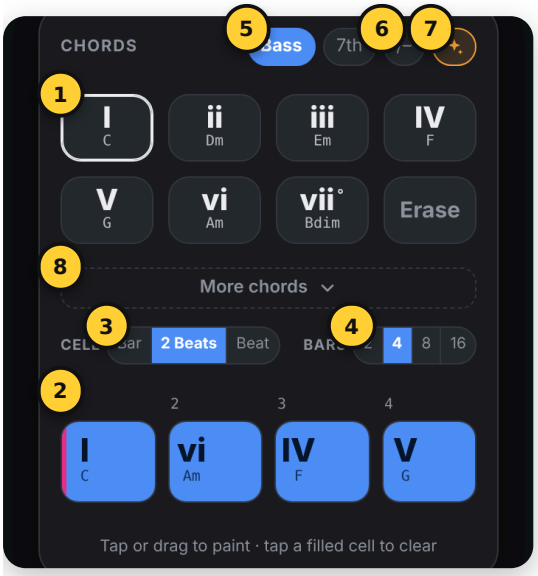


1. The section this slot plays.
2. The section's role (Intro · Verse · Pre · Chorus · Bridge · Outro).
3. Key of this slot: −3 to +5 semitones from the song's key. Chord names, accompaniment and MIDI follow it, and the slot's melody moves with it.
4. Tempo of this slot: Song follows the song's BPM; − + or typing sets this slot's own.
5. Move · duplicate · delete the slot.

> If the section is used in other slots, only this slot is split off as its own section (C′). The Roll and Staff show the new key and tempo too.

5 Chords

Pick a chord in the palette and paint it on the grid of the selected section.

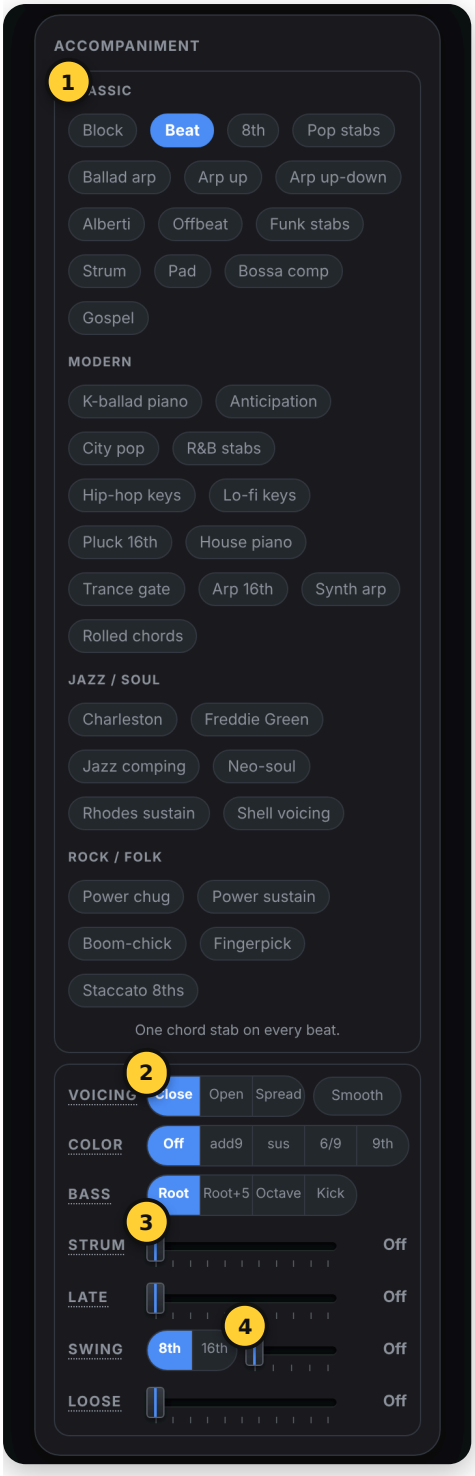


1. Palette: the chords of the key and scale, as numerals and names. Tap to hear and select; Erase is the eraser.
2. Grid: tap or drag to paint. Tap a painted cell again to clear it.
3. Cell: length of one cell (bar · 2 beats · beat) — how often chords can change.
4. Bars: length of this section (2 · 4 · 8 · 16).
5. Bass: bass part on / off. 7th: all chords as sevenths.
6. /– : slash chords. Pick the scale note for the bass, then paint.
7. Dice (Random): a random progression (current pop and K-ballad ones included) plus a random accompaniment style and drum pattern. Color starts off; press Play to hear it. With a melody in the slot it becomes a sparkle button (Suggest) that proposes chords for the melody (chapter 13).
8. More chords: chords outside the scale (borrowed chords, secondary dominants …).

> Not happy? Undo brings the previous progression back at any time.

6 Accompaniment

How the chords are played. Each section can have its own (e.g. arpeggios in the verse, strumming in the chorus).

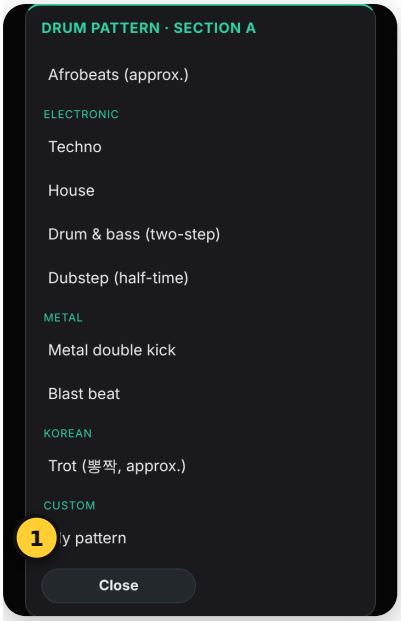


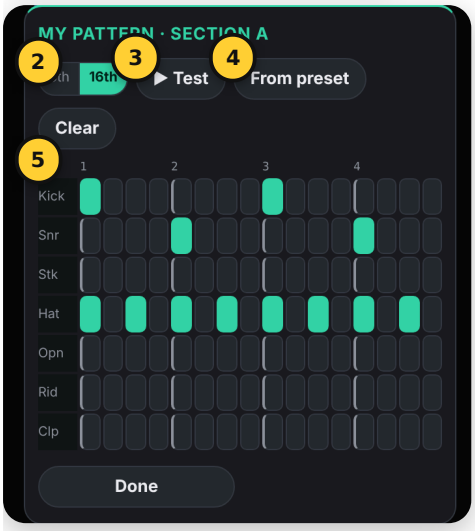
1. Style: Classic · Modern · Jazz/Soul · Rock/Folk. Picking one also sets the options below to suit it.
2. Voicing · Color · Bass: how the chord is stacked (close · open · spread · smooth), colour tones (add9 · sus · 6/9 · 9th), bass rhythm (root · root+5 · octave · on the kick).
3. Strum · Late: spread the notes like a guitar, play the chords slightly behind the beat.
4. Swing · Loose: 8th/16th shuffle, a little human timing.

> Tap an option's underlined name for a short help text. Some styles are 4/4 only.

7 Drums

The arrow next to the drum button opens the patterns. Each section keeps its own pattern.

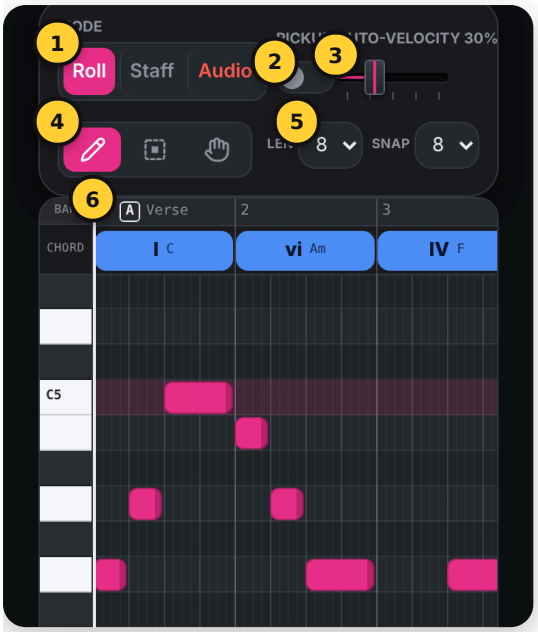




1. Tap a pattern to hear it and turn the drums on. My pattern, at the bottom, opens its editor.
2. 8th / 16th: 8 or 16 steps per bar.
3. Test: play the pattern alone, in a loop.
4. From preset: start from the pattern last picked in the list. Clear empties it.
5. Tap cells on each row (kick · snare · side stick · hi-hat · open hat · ride · clap). Done closes it.

8 Piano roll (Roll)

The Melody Track's main view. The chord lane on top shows the Chord Track as a guide.

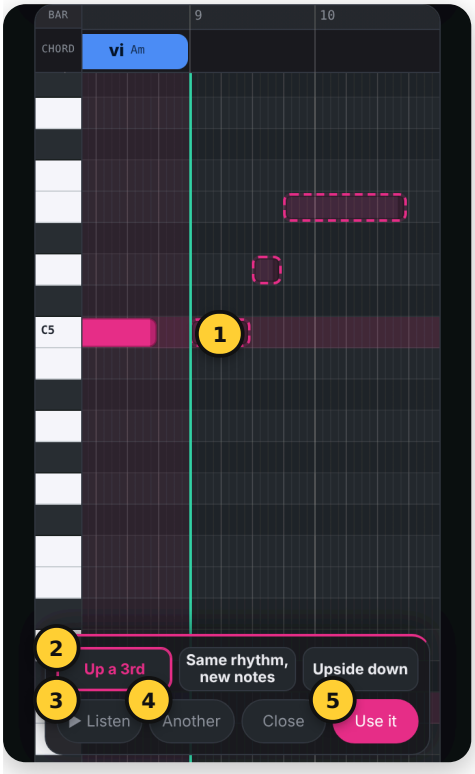


1. Mode: Roll · Staff · Audio (singing). Switching does not stop playback.
2. Pickup: add a pickup bar before the song.
3. Auto-Velocity: accents the melody on the beat (0% = flat, 100% = strongest).
4. Tools — Pen: tap empty space to add, drag to change length or pitch, tap a note to delete. Select: draw a box, then copy · paste · move · octave · delete. Hand: scroll without editing.
5. Len · Snap: length of new notes, and the grid they snap to.
6. Chord lane: chords and section names per bar. − + at the bottom right zoom in and out.

> In a slot with its own key, the rows show that key's scale and tonic. For ✦ Continue at the bottom left see chapter 9.

9 Continue the melody

✦ Continue, at the bottom left of the Roll or Staff, takes the last two bars before the cursor as a motif and shows a dashed idea for the next two bars.

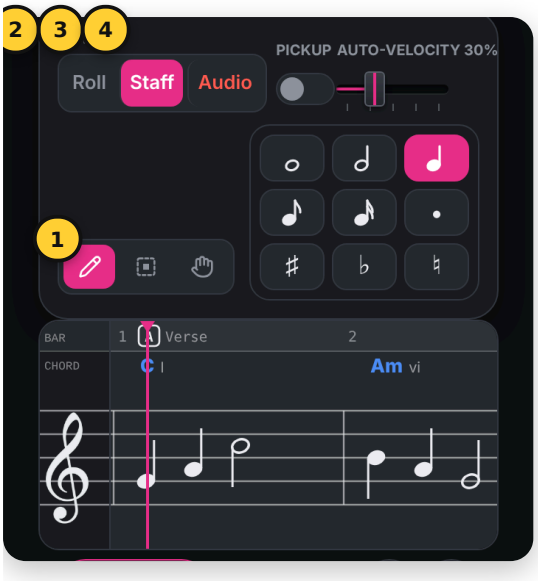


1. Dashed notes: the idea. The two bars it grew from are tinted, the seam is the green line.
2. How it varies: up a 3rd (tap again: up a step · a 5th · down a step · a 3rd), the same rhythm on the chord tones there, or the intervals turned upside down.
3. Listen: the two bars and the idea, with the backing.
4. Another: another idea of the same kind.
5. Use it: add it to the melody. Close, or simply writing your own, ignores it.

> The first note of each bar lands near a chord tone. If the next section is in another key, the idea moves into it.

10 Staff

The same melody as notation, written directly.

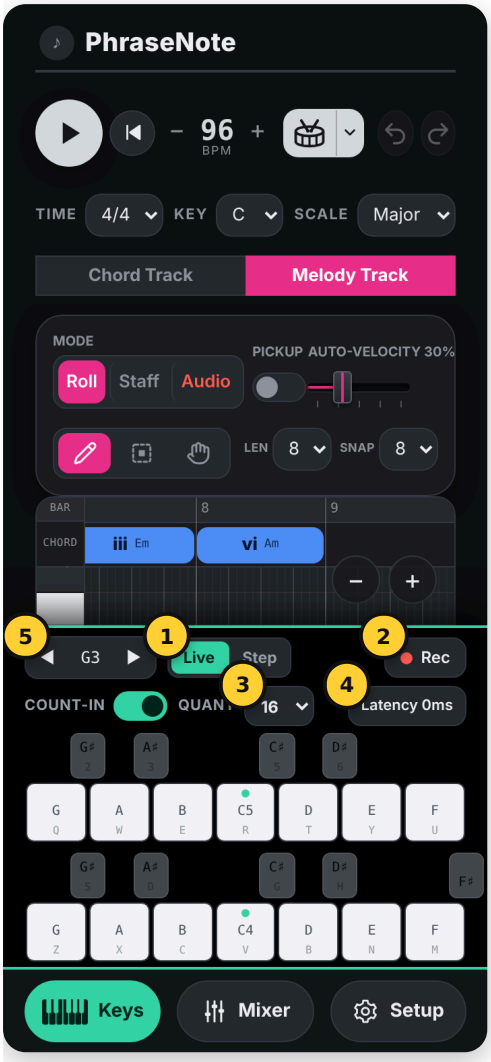


1. Tools: Pen · Select · Hand (as in the roll).
2. Note value: whole to sixteenth. Pick it, then tap the stave.
3. Dot: one and a half times as long.
4. Accidental: ♯ ♭ ♮.

> Hold on the stave and drag up or down to hear the pitch; let go to place it. Selected notes move with ▲▼ (semitone) and ◀▶ (sixteenth). Where a slot is in another key, a double bar and the new key signature appear, and accidentals follow that key.

11 Playing it in (Keys)

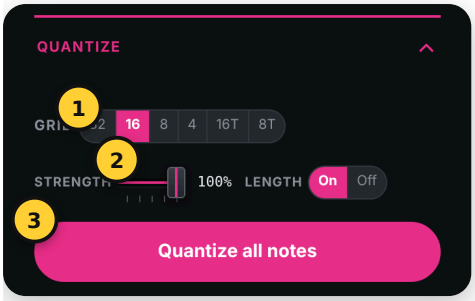
Keys at the bottom opens an on-screen keyboard (Roll and Staff modes).



1. Live / Step: Live records what you play in time; Step adds one note per key press (length = Len).
2. Rec: arm it, then Play: one bar count-in, then recording (Count-in can be switched off).
3. Quant: snap recorded notes to 16ths, 8ths or quarters.
4. Latency: measure the phone's audio delay so recordings line up. Worth doing once.
5. ◀ ▶: shift the keyboard range.

12 Quantize

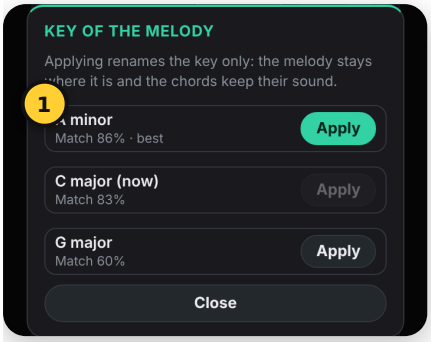
Tidies the timing of all notes. Open Quantize under the melody.

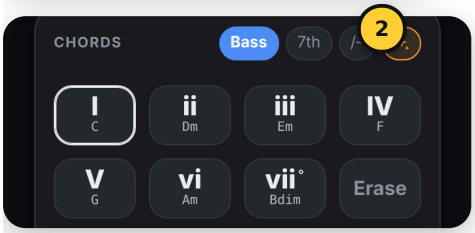


1. Grid: what to snap to (32nd to quarter, triplets 16T · 8T).
2. Strength: how far to pull (100% = exactly on the grid, 50% = half way).
3. Quantize all notes: do it. With Length on, note lengths are tidied too.

13 Key and chords from the melody

Wrote the melody first? The app suggests a key and chords that fit it.

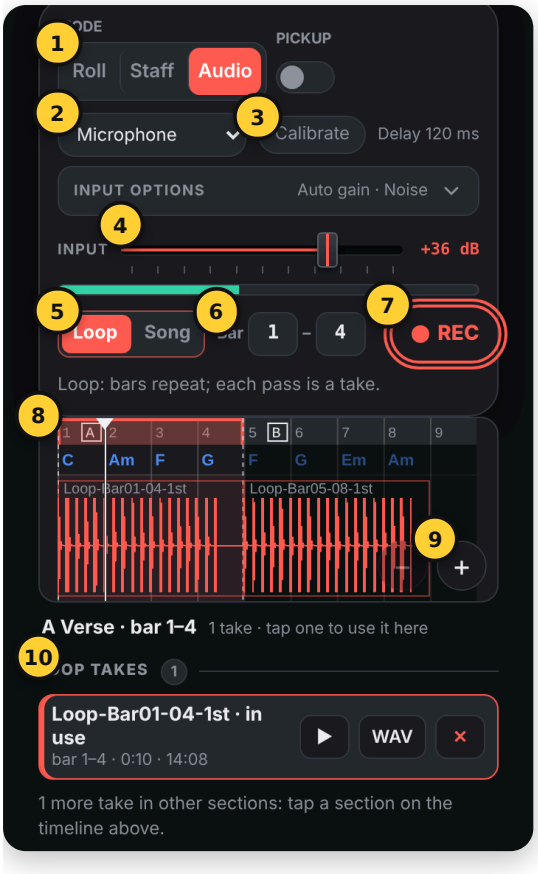




1. Key guess: “Guess from melody…” at the top of the Key list shows three likely keys. Apply only renames the key; the melody and chords sound the same.
2. Suggest: in a slot with melody, the Chord Track’s dice becomes a sparkle button. Tap it to fill empty cells with chords that fit the melody; tap again for another option (up to five).

14 Singing (Audio)

Choose Audio in Mode to record with the microphone over the backing. Wired earphones keep the backing out of the recording.

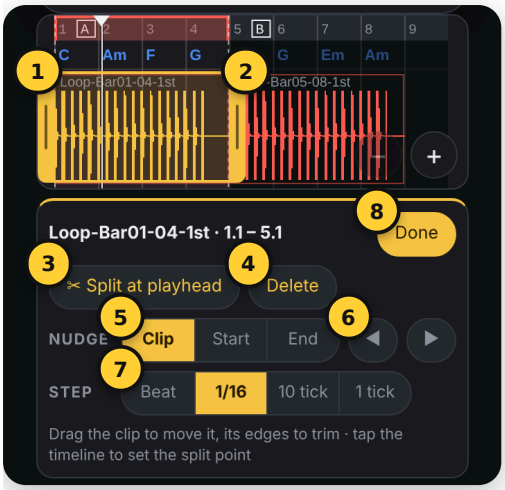


1. Audio in Mode. The microphone is on in this mode only.
2. Input device: usually leave as it is.
3. Calibrate: once, earphones out and volume up. The speaker's clicks are recorded back to measure the delay, and recordings are placed accordingly.
4. Input: microphone boost (0–48 dB, +36 by default). Sing your loudest part and aim for the meter below to reach about orange; if the number turns red, lower it. Input options switch auto gain, noise suppression and echo cancellation.
5. Loop / Song: Loop repeats the bars you set and keeps every pass as a take; Song records from the playhead until Stop.
6. Bars to loop: first and last bar (inclusive). Playback loops them too; outside is dimmed.
7. REC: one bar of backing, then recording. Tap again to stop and keep the take.
8. Timeline: tap a section to select it (the playhead moves there too). The take chosen for each section is shown in place, and they play together. Swipe sideways to scroll; long-press a clip to edit it (chapter 15).
9. − + : zoom the timeline. All the way out, the whole song fits.
10. Takes of the selected section, grouped as Song takes and Loop takes. Tap a row to use that take here (tap again to un-use). ▶ listen from this section · WAV export · ✕ delete (Undo brings it back).

> Takes are named like Song-Bar01-1st or Loop-Bar01-04-2nd. To silence the MIDI melody while recording, mute MIDI in the mixer.

15 Editing audio clips

Long-press a clip on the timeline: it gets a yellow frame and the edit panel opens. A clip is one piece of the take used in a section.

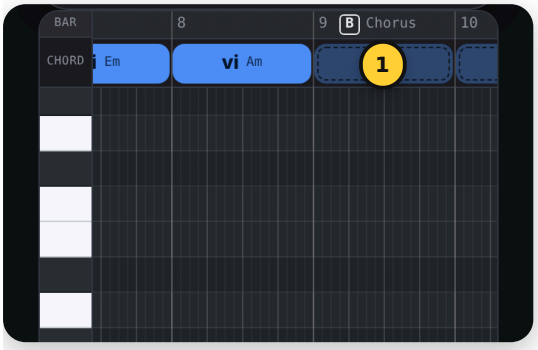


1. Start handle: drag to trim the start, or to bring it back. The handle's inner edge is the edit point.
2. End handle: the same for the end. Drag the middle of the clip to move all of it.
3. Split at playhead: tap the timeline to put the playhead inside the clip, then split it there.
4. Delete: remove the clip. To remove part of it, split first.
5. Nudge: what the arrows move — Clip (all of it) · Start · End.
6. ◀ ▶: move it by one Step.
7. Step: the unit for dragging and the arrows — Beat · 1/16 · 10 tick · 1 tick.
8. Done: leave the edit mode.

> Tap an empty stretch between clips: it is selected (dashed green) and tapping a take in the list fills just that gap. A clip moved or stretched over another cuts it. Every edit can be undone.

16 Keep going with Loop

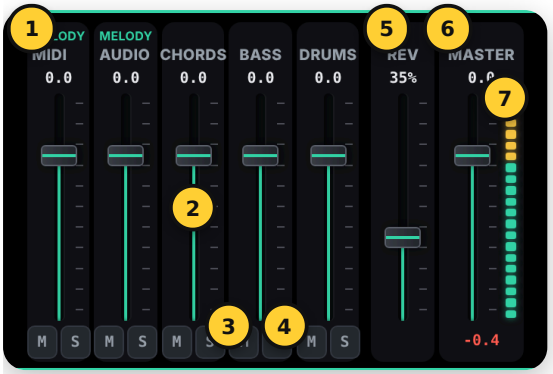
With the Chord Track on Loop, the Melody Track repeats the selected slot too, and the song grows as you keep writing.



1. Select the last slot and a dashed copy of it waits after the song. Draw notes in it and it becomes real, with a new dashed copy after it.
2. Recording (singing or Keys Live) does not jump back at the end of the slot: the next copy is made ahead of time and recording carries on.
3. Looping an earlier slot inserts the copies right after it; later sections and their melody move back.
4. Copies left without notes after a Keys recording are removed when you stop. Singing keeps the copies it passed.

17 Mixer

Mixer at the bottom opens it. Level, mute and solo per part; saved with the project.

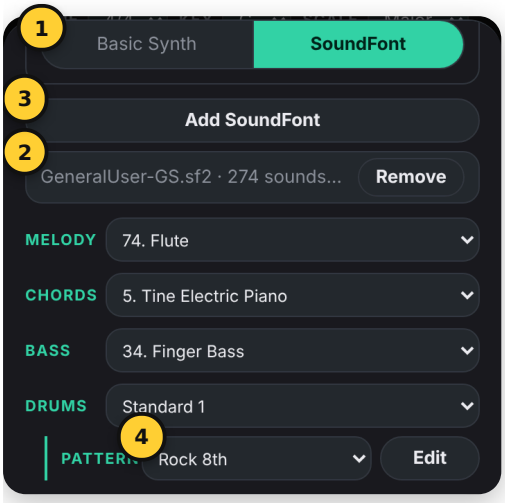


1. Channels: Melody MIDI (notes) · Melody Audio (recordings) · Chords · Bass · Drums.
2. Fader: drag up or down. 0.0 dB is the default, up to +12 dB. Double-tap to reset. A short buzz marks each tick.
3. M (mute): silence the channel.
4. S (solo): only soloed channels play; several can be soloed.
5. Rev: reverb amount (SoundFont sounds).
6. Master: overall level.
7. Level meter: what actually comes out. Inside yellow is right; if the top red lights often, lower Master. The number is the recent peak.

> MIDI files carry each track's fader as its volume.

18 Sound (SoundFont)

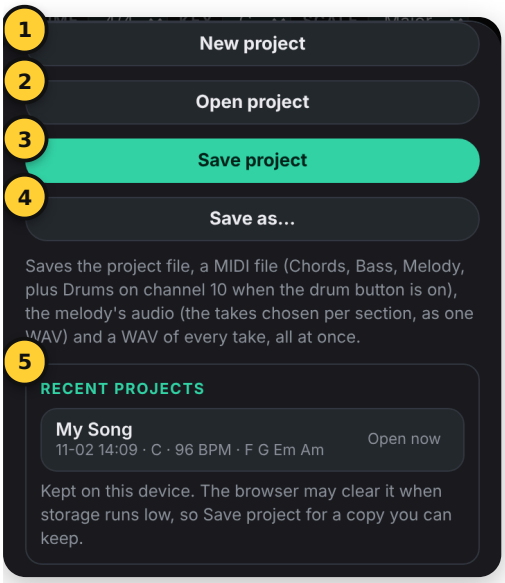
In Setup → Sound.



1. Basic Synth works without files; SoundFont plays the samples in a .sf2 file.
2. Loaded banks. The built-in GeneralUser GS is there from the start. If removed, "Use the built-in GeneralUser GS" fetches it again.
3. Add SoundFont: add other .sf2 files and pick an instrument for Melody · Chords · Bass · Drums. Loaded files stay on the phone. Save / Load preset stores the instruments together with the mixer balance.
4. Drum pattern and Edit (the editor from chapter 7).

19 Saving and opening

In Setup → Project.



1. New project (tap twice to confirm).
2. Open project: a saved .zip or .phrasenote file. Recordings come back too.
3. Save project: one .zip in Downloads with the project file, a MIDI file, Melody.wav (the takes chosen per section, joined) and a WAV per take. Asks for a name only the first time, then saves over it.
4. Save as: a copy under a new name; it suggests My Song v2, v3 …
5. Recent projects: the last 10 are kept on the phone and open with one tap.

> The MIDI file has Chords · Bass · Melody · Drums (when on) as separate tracks, with the slots' tempo and key changes, ready to continue in a DAW.

20 Notes

- The app's data lives in the browser's storage. Clearing site data or uninstalling the browser can delete it, so back up with Save project.
- Record in the installed app or at its address; previews inside other apps may block the microphone. If the permission was refused, allow it again in the browser's site settings.
- Bluetooth earphones add too much delay for recording; wired ones are recommended.
- Files are saved to Downloads as a .zip.
- Some accompaniment styles and genre drums are 4/4 only; patterns approximate a genre's feel.
- Recordings keep the speed they were recorded at: change a slot's tempo after recording and its takes may drift (the take list then says "tempo changed since").
- The time signature is one for the whole song.